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March 7, 1966

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. UU-E-00525 (SA)
August 4, 1965 and
Fed. Spec. G-E-530a
May 18, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ENVELOPE, MAILING (RADIOGRAPHIC FILM)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers envelopes used for mailing exposed and developed 14- by 17-inch radiographic films and related reports, correspondence, or records.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Styles and classes.* Envelopes in accordance with this specification shall be of the following styles and classes, as specified (see 6.2).

Style I—Button and string closure.
Style II—Gummed flap closure.
Class A—Without small attached envelope.
Class B—With small attached envelope.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specificaton to the extent specified:

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Test Methods.

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(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, N. Y.)

Technical Manual of the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Executive Secretary, AATCC National Headquarters, Lowell, Mass., or Howes Publishing Corporation, 44 East 23rd Street, New York, N. Y.)

Post Office Department: Postal Regulations.

(Copies are obtainable from the Post Office Department, Washington, D. C., 20260.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 *Paper.* The mailing envelope and the small envelope (class B, only) shall be made from paper conforming to the physical characteristics in table I when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

TABLE I. *Physical characteristics of envelope papers*

Characteristic	Requirement	
	Mailing envelope	Small envelope
Stock (fiber identification)	100 percent sulphate pulp	100 percent sulphate pulp
Basis weight (17 by 22-500)	32 pounds, plus or minus 5 percent	24 pounds, plus or minus 5 percent
Bursting strength	60 points (minimum)	44 points (minimum)
Acidity, pH	5.0 (minimum)	5.0 (minimum)

3.1.2 *Chipboard.* The insert shall be made from chipboard having a thickness of 0.040 ± 0.005 inch, and a pH (acidity) value of not less than 5.0 when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The chipboard shall be without liner or coating.

3.2 **Construction.** Styles I and II mailing envelopes shall be constructed as follows and shall be furnished with a chipboard insert conforming to 3.7. In addition to the chipboard insert, class B mailing envelopes shall have a small envelope conforming to 3.6 glued on the lower right outside.

3.2.1 *Envelope.* The envelope shall be made of paper conforming to 3.1.1 and shall be either center seam, or side seam construction, open end style. The center or side seam shall be at least 5/8-inch wide, and the bottom seam shall be at least 1 inch wide, and shall be beveled inward on both sides. The seams shall be gummed the entire length and width, to assure complete and permanent adhesion. The opening and flap shall extend the full width of the 15-inch end of the envelope, with the sides of the flap tapered inward. The fold line of the flap shall be scored.

3.2.1.1 *Style I.* Style I mailing envelopes shall be provided with a flap not less than 2 inches wide. A button and cord fastener shall be provided for closing the envelope.

3.2.1.2 *Style II.* Style II mailing envelopes shall be provided with a gummed flap not less than 2-1/2 inches wide. The width of the adhesive on the flap shall be a minimum of one inch from the outer edge extending inward. The flap shall be capable of being quickly and securely sealed by ordinary pressure when subjected to moisture. The adhesive material shall be free from ingredients which tend to discolor the paper, and shall be of such consistency when applied as to prevent curling or premature adhesion.

3.3 **Printing.** Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), mailing envelopes shall have the following printed matter in plain black letters.

3.3.1 *Class A.* The legend "Postage and Fees Paid" shall be printed in the upper right hand corner with letters approximately 1/8-inch high. The word "From" shall be printed in the upper left hand corner, with letters approximately 1/4-inch high. Four horizontal lines (parallel with the long side of the envelope) approximately 3 inches long, and spaced approximately 3/8-inch apart, shall be printed under the word "From". The words "Official Business" shall be printed under the lines, in letters

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approximately 1/8-inch high. The legend "X-Ray Film, Do Not Bend or Fold" shall be printed in heavy block letters at least 1/4-inch across the center of the envelope, in one or two lines. The legend "Letter or Report may be enclosed" shall be printed in the lower right-hand corner in letters approximately 1/8-inch high over the address area which shall consist of the word "to", and four horizontal lines approximately 4-1/2 inches long spaced approximately 1/2-inch apart.

3.3.2 *Class B.* For return address there shall be printed in the upper left-hand corner of the envelope the following:

(a) The word "FROM" in suitable size.
(b) Three horizontal lines below the word "FROM" spaced approximately 3/8-inch apart and 3-1/2 inches long.
(c) Below the three lines in suitable type the legend "Postmaster—Return in Ten Days if not Delivered.—Return Postage Guaranteed."

Across the front of the center of the large envelope there shall be printed in type approximately 5/16-inch high, the following legend:—X-Ray Film—Do Not Fold."

3.4 **Size.** The dimensions of the mailing envelope when closed shall be 15 ± 1/8 inch by 18 ± 1/8 inch.

3.5 **Color and finish.** The mailing envelope shall be a light-colored brown (kraft shade) and the finish shall be smooth, suitable for writing on with ink when tested in accordance with 4.4.2.

3.6 **Small envelope (class B, only).** The small envelope for class B, mailing envelopes shall be made of paper conforming to 3.1.1. The small envelope shall be 3-7/8 ± 3/8 inch by 8-7/8 ± 1/8 inch, and shall have a gummed flap on one long side. The legend "This envelope contains a letter" shall be printed in black on the small envelope.

3.7 **Insert.** An insert cut from chipboard conforming to 3.1.2 shall be placed in each mailing envelope. The insert shall be 14-1/2 ± 1/8 inch by 17-1/2 ± 1/8 inch.

3.8 **Postal regulations.** The mailing envelopes shall comply in all respects with the applicable U. S. Postal Regulations.

3.9 **Workmanship.** The film mailing envelopes shall be uniformly made, and shall be free from defects with respect to color, cleanliness, pinholes, breaks, tears, cuts sharp creases or wrinkles. The chipboard inserts shall have well finished edges and shall be free from surface lumps, chip indentations, creases, wrinkles, cracks, breaks, blows, blisters, or soil which may impair the serviceability or tend to mar or scratch the films.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 **Inspection responsibility.** The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Inspection of components and materials.** In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible, for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications and standards.

4.2.1 *Paper stock and chipboard.* The paper stock for the mailing envelope and small envelope and the chipboard used for the insert shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1 for compliance with 3.1. The lots of paper stock and chipboard, as applicable, expressed in pounds, shall consist of all material received from one source of sup-

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ply for use in the manufacture and assembly of the end item. The test sample unit shall consist of at least 1000 square inches of material. The sample size shall be as shown below. Test results shall include all values upon which the results are based and there shall be no failure to meet the composite or lot average requirements. The composite sample shall consist of at least 60 square inches of the base paper component made up by combining approximately equal portions of small pieces from all of the sample units selected.

Lot size (pounds of base stock or chipboard, as applicable)	Sample size (No. of sample units)
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 or more	5

4.3 Sampling and inspection for lot acceptance. Sampling and inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For sampling purposes, a lot shall consist of all envelopes of one style and class presented for inspection at one time.

4.3.1 *Inspection of the end item.* The sample unit shall be one complete mailing envelope and the lot size shall be the number of envelopes in the inspection lot.

4.3.1.1 *Visual examination.* Mailing envelopes shall be examined for the defects in table II. Inspection level S-3 shall apply and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE II. *Visual defects in the end item*

Examine	Defect
Materials	Any material not as specified.
Construction	Wrong style or class.
	Insert missing.
	Small envelope (class B, only) missing, loose, or not attached as specified.
	Seams not constructed as specified or not completely sealed.
	Flap not constructed as specified.
	Flap and opening not properly located.
	Fold line of flap not scored.
Construction (cont'd)	Wrong type of flap closure or closure missing.
	Flap of style II curled, discolored, or partially sealed.
Printing	Any deviation from specified printing.
	Printing illegible.
Color and finish	Color or finish not as specified.
Workmanship	Holes, cuts, tears, wrinkles, sharp folds or creases, spots or soil on envelope.
	Ragged edges, surface bumps, chip indentations, cracks, blows, blisters, or soil on chipboard.
	Any imperfection which may tend to mar or scratch film contents.

4.3.1.2 *Dimensional examination.* The mailing envelopes shall be examined for conformance with specified dimensions. Any dimension not within specified tolerances shall constitute a defect. Inspection level S-4 shall apply and the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

4.3.1.3 *Testing of the end item.* The mailing envelopes shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.2 to determine compliance with 3.5. Inspection level S-2 shall apply and the AQL shall be 1.5 percent defective.

4.3.2 *Examination of the preparation for delivery.* The packaging, packing, and marking shall be examined to determine compliance with the requirements of section 5 of this specification, and any special requirements in the contract or order. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot and the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packed and selected prior to the sealing operation. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for closure defects. Inspection level S-2 shall apply and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units. Examination shall be made for the defects listed in table III.

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TABLE III. *Defects in preparation for delivery*

Examine	Defect
Marking (interior and exterior container)	Omitted or incomplete. Incorrect or illegible. Improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective. Any component not as specified.
Packing	Improper method of closure. Box not compact or well filled. Flaps of envelopes not extended.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of liners, container flaps, strapping or taping. Bulging, distorted, or damaged container.
Content	Number per container is more or less than required.

4.4 Test procedures.

4.4.1 *Paper and chipboard.* Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.1 shall be conditioned in accordance with TAPPI Method T-402m-49 and tested in accordance with table IV.

4.4.2 *Writing quality.* Samples selected in accordance with 4.3.1.3 shall be tested as follows for conformance with 3.5:

Lines shall be drawn on different portions of the sample with a 1 percent aqueous solution of either Color Index 18050, C. I. Acid Red 1, or Color Index 42085, C. I. Acid Green 3, in accordance with AATCC Color Index. There shall be no visible feathering, spreading, ragged edges, or skips.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Fed. Std. No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and application of the various levels of packing for civil procurements.)

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* One hundred mailing envelopes with flaps extended shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, class weather-resistant, grade V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), 100 mailing envelopes with flaps extended shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF or SF, class domestic of PPP-B-636, except that the minimum bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be 200 p.s.i. The shipping container shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the container specification.

5.1.3 *Level C.* One hundred mailing envelopes with flaps extended shall be packed in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice to assure carrier acceptance for safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with rules

TABLE IV. *Testing of paper and chipboard*

Characteristic	TAPPI test method	Requirements applicable to		Number determinations per sample unit
		Comp.	Lot average	
Fiber identification	T-401m-60	x		2 (on composite)
Basis weight	T-410os-61		x	1 (1000 sq. in. specimen)
Bursting strength	T-403ts-63		x	10 (5 per side)
Acidity, pH	T-435m-52 (Hot extraction)	x		2 (on composite)
Thickness	T-411m-44		x	20

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or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 **Marking.**

5.2.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 *Military requirements.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** The envelope covered by this specification is intended as a mailing envelope for exposed and developed radiographic films and related reports, correspondence or records from Federal Government medical activities.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Style and class required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Special printing requirements (see 3.3).
(*d*) Level of packing required (see 5.1).
(*e*) Special quantities to be packed (see 5.1.2).

6.3 The procurement agency should require certification of compliance with postal regulations (see 3.8).

6.4 **Transportation descriptions.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weight applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Envelopes, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Motor:

Envelopes, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL
Navy—SA
Air Force—69

Review Activities:

Army—GL
Navy—SA
Air Force—69

Preparing Activity:

Navy—SA

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